```
      "title": {}
    }
  }
}
```

The field we want to highlight

The following code highlights the word *Godfather* with `<em>` tags. The source is suppressed in the results because we set `_source` to `false` in the query:

```
{
  ...
  "highlight" : { "title" : ["The <em>Godfather</em>"] }
},
{
  ...
  "highlight" : { "title" : ["The <em>Godfather</em> II"]}
}
```

We use `<em>` tags to emphasize the font in HTML-based browsers. We can also use custom tags. For example, this code creates a pair of curly braces ({{ and }}) as a tag:

```
...
"highlight": {
    "pre_tags": "{{",
    "post_tags": "}}",
    "fields": {
      "title": {}
    }
  }
```

The result is `"The {{Godfather}}"` (with curly braces as the highlights). Now that we know how to highlight search results, let's turn our attention to relevancy scores in data.

### 8.8.3 Explaining relevancy scores

Elasticsearch provides a mechanism that tells us exactly how the engine calculates relevancy scores. This is achieved using an `explain` flag on a `_search` endpoint or an `explain` API. The `explain` API is also used to determine why a document has or has not matched a query. In this section, we look at both of these methods to understand their commonalities and subtle differences.

#### THE EXPLAIN FLAG

You may have noticed a positive number (a relevancy score value) in some of the earlier query results. Those values were computed and set by the engine, but we didn't explain how. If we are curious about the calculation, Elasticsearch provides a flag called `explain` that we can set in the body of the query. When we set the `explain` attribute to `true`, Elasticsearch returns the results with the details of how it arrived at that score. In other words, it explains the logic and calculations carried out by the engine behind the scenes.

The following listing shows a `match` query. Because we want to know how the scores are calculated, we set `explain` to `true`.